

How To Know When To Say No

1. Pareto Principle (80/20 Rule)

Maximizes efficiency by focusing on the most impactful options.



20% Effort

- Identify tasks that require low effort but have high impact.

80% Results

- Focus on these tasks to get the best results.

Say yes

- Prioritize these high-impact tasks..

Say no

- Minimize or outsource the rest.

2. Eisenhower Matrix (Urgent-Important Matrix)

Efficiently prioritizes options by urgency and importance.

Urgent & Important

- Say yes and put the majority of your focus here.

Not Urgent & Important*

- Say not right now but consider doing these next not now.

Urgent & Not Important

- Say no or delegate these.

Not Urgent & Not Important

- Say no to these. I always store a list of these in case things change.

	Important	Not Important
Urgent	Yes	No
Not Urgent	No*	No

3. OKRs (Objectives and Key Results)

Identify what does and does not align with organizational goals through measurable results.

Objectives

- Define clear, achievable goals.

Key Results

- Establish measurable outcomes to track progress towards these goals.

Say yes

- To those with clear alignment with the OKRs

Say no

- When they are not fully aligned with the OKRs



4. The MoSCoW Method

Effectively prioritizes options based on their importance and necessity.

Say
Yes

★★★★ Must have

★★★ Should have

Say
No

★★ Could have

★ Won't have

Must have

- Say yes to items critical to project success.

Should have

- Say not right now to important but not critical item.

Could have

- Nice to have but not necessary items. Say no.

Won't have

- Items that can be eliminated or postponed.

5. RICE Scoring Model

Prioritizes projects based on quantifiable data to make objective decisions.



Reach

- Assess the project's potential audience size.

Impact

- Gauge the project's contribution to goals.

Confidence

- Evaluate certainty in your estimates.

Effort

- Measure the work needed for the task.

6. The Kano Model

Enhances your results by identifying the priorities that will drive the most benefit

Must-Be

- Essential for basic satisfaction.

Performance

- Improve satisfaction proportionally.

Attractive

- Surprise with delight.

